error. Without the type checking, at some point we'd try to do something with the Integer that expects a string—in this case, there's no harm in letting the code go to that point, but in a complex system there is some advantage in not letting code go any further than necessary. Sorbet's runtime checking can also catch dynamic method calls that would be challenging for the static type checker to analyze.

What's Next

To be honest, we're a little conflicted about types in Ruby. We like the potential performance benefit, and the tooling advantages are promising. There's definitely a communication benefit to being explicit with types. We do worry, though, that some of Ruby's dynamic power and flexibility is being traded for static typing, and for developers who came to Ruby for that flexibility, that can be a hard tradeoff.

Some of that communication benefit can also come from documentation. In the next chapter, we'll discuss RDoc, the official Ruby documentation solution, and YARD, a commonly used third-party extension.